
Gerhard Duerksen - Abbotsford

12 messages

Mike Dirksen <707mike@gmail.com>

Wed, Sep 13, 2017 at 5:30 PM

To: Glenn Penner <gpenner@uoguelph.ca>, Tim Janzen <tjanzen@comcast.net>

I have found this:

Gerhard is GRANDMA #34181

Direct male Descendant of David Cornelius Dircks (1761-1818).

GRANDMA: Birth Source: Die Mennonitische Rundschau, page 24 Jul 1968, p4

Michael D. "Mike" Dirksen

#850839

427 Manzanita Dr

Angwin, CA 94508

707 492-2464

Glenn Penner <gpenner@uoguelph.ca>

Wed, Sep 13, 2017 at 7:06 PM

To: Mike Dirksen <707mike@gmail.com>

Cc: "tjanzen@comcast.net" <tjanzen@comcast.net>

Hi Mike,

I had a chance to compare your Y-DNA results to those of George Duerksen this morning. The match is very good. I think that this is good evidence that your ancestor Johann Cornelius #14630 was the brother to David #14628 (1761-1818).

There is no documentation showing that David's father was a Cornelius so the name David Cornelius is incorrect (and does not appear in the GRANDMA database). The Menn. Rundschau source below is for the birth of George Duerksen.

Here are a few pieces of circumstantial evidence that Johann Cornelius and David were likely brothers (or, at least closely related):

- 1) The Y-DNA match of the direct male descendants of Johann Cornelius and David. Especially since these two do not match any of the other Dirks/Dirksen/etc. men and represent a rather small family group (which may have originated with a Kerber man)
- 2) Johann Cornelius and David were born in the same small region of West Prussia (the Tragheimerweide congregation)
- 3) Johann Cornelius and David were born within a few years of each other (1760s)
- 4) David Dirksen named his first son Cornelius, in accordance with the tradition.

I would not go as far as making Johann Cornelius and David brothers in the GRANDMA database. I do think that complementary notes should go with both of them showing why they were likely brothers. People could then decide for themselves.

Glenn.

From: Mike Dirksen <707mike@gmail.com>
Sent: Wednesday, September 13, 2017 8:30 PM
To: Glenn Penner; Tim Janzen
Subject: Gerhard Duerksen - Abbotsford

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Mike Dirksen <707mike@gmail.com> Wed, Sep 13, 2017 at 8:47 PM
To: Micah Dirksen <molex1000@gmail.com>, Lex Dirksen <707lex@gmail.com>

Glenn Penner is a prominent Canadian Mennonite Genealogist.
I met him once at the Fresno Hiebert Library Archive.

I am very pleased that he has been personally involved in a quest for Dirksen origins.

This email is a result of several years of inquiry.

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Tim Janzen <tjanzen@comcast.net> Wed, Sep 13, 2017 at 9:51 PM
To: Glenn Penner <gpenner@uoguelph.ca>, Mike Dirksen <707mike@gmail.com>

I added notes to 14628 and 70539 that the Y haplotypes of their descendents suggest that 14628 and 70539 were closely related to each other.

Tim

From: Glenn Penner [<mailto:gpenner@uoguelph.ca>]
Sent: Wednesday, September 13, 2017 7:07 PM
To: Mike Dirksen
Cc: tjanzen@comcast.net
Subject: Re: Gerhard Duerksen - Abbotsford

Hi Mike,

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Glenn Penner <gpenner@uoguelph.ca> Fri, Sep 15, 2017 at 10:03 AM

To: Tim Janzen <tjanzen@comcast.net>, Mike Dirksen <707mike@gmail.com>

Hello Mike and Tim,

I've been looking at the ancestry of the various Dirks/Doerksen/Dirksen/Duerksen/etc. men who have participated in the Mennonite DNA project. The ancestries of the 7 men, other than Mike and George, are all Flemish or Old Flemish. This means that the only men with Frisian Mennonite ancestry in the project are Mike and George. This means two things:

- 1) the haplotypes for Mike and George may not be unique to their specific ancestry (but could be shared by all the Dirks/Doerksen/Dirksen/Duerksen/etc. men with Frisian ancestry).
- 2) the match to the Kerber men may not be unique to Mike and George.

We need more Dirks/Doerksen/Dirksen/Duerksen/etc. men of Frisian ancestry in the project in order to determine if the entire Frisian branch is related to the Kerbers. This could be similar to the main branch of the Peters family, who are related to the Hiebert/Hueberts.

I also have some suggested corrections to the families of Johann ((#14630) and David (#14628) Duerksen, which I will send in a separate email.

Glenn.

From: Tim Janzen <tjanzen@comcast.net>
Sent: Thursday, September 14, 2017 12:51 AM
To: Glenn Penner; 'Mike Dirksen'
Subject: RE: Gerhard Duerksen - Abbotsford

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Mike Dirksen <707mike@gmail.com> Fri, Sep 15, 2017 at 10:06 AM
To: Glenn Penner <gpenner@uoguelph.ca>, Tim Janzen <tjanzen@comcast.net>

Thank you VERY much for this interesting update! I am very excited about this information and eager to learn more.

Mike Dirksen

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Sent from Gmail Mobile

Glenn Penner <gpenner@uoguelph.ca> Fri, Sep 15, 2017 at 12:07 PM
To: Mike Dirksen <707mike@gmail.com>, Tim Janzen <tjanzen@comcast.net>

Mike,

You may have seen this already. If you look at <http://www.mennonitegenealogy.com/prussia/marienw.htm> and go down to #171 you'll see a Johann Dirks of Schweingrube who sold a Morgen of land in 1819. I think that it's more than just coincidence that the same year Johann Dirks of Schweingrube immigrated to Russia. I'm certain that this is your ancestor. A Morgen of land was just over 1 1/3 acres. Probably enough for a house, barn, garden and cow pasture.

Glenn.

From: Mike Dirksen <707mike@gmail.com>

Sent: Friday, September 15, 2017 1:06 PM

To: Glenn Penner; Tim Janzen

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[Quoted text hidden]

Mike Dirksen <707mike@gmail.com>

Fri, Sep 15, 2017 at 3:23 PM

To: Glenn Penner <gpenner@uoguelph.ca>

Cc: Tim Janzen <tjanzen@comcast.net>

Johann K Duerksen #14630 is the man John F Duerksen #14704 described (<http://www.dakotadirksens.com/1928/>) thus, "During the French War in 1812, he lodged French soldiers in his home....they, in turn, treated him in a friendly manner.....paid for what they took.....He was a butter, cheese and sausage dealer." If true that his was the Morgen of land sold in 1819, and it was all he had, "dealer" rather than "producer" is reasonable.

Mike =]

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Mike Dirksen <707mike@gmail.com>

Fri, Sep 15, 2017 at 4:16 PM

To: Glenn Penner <gpenner@uoguelph.ca>

The same land record shows on line 16 (<http://www.mennonitegenealogy.com/prussia/marienw.htm>) Kreis Schwetz (possible Alexanderthal farm #12 (<http://www.dakotadirksens.com/alexanderthal/>) P. Funk #60199, whose grand daughters married grandsons of Johann K Duerksen #14630 farm #11.

Mike

On Fri, Sep 15, 2017 at 12:07 PM, Glenn Penner <gpenner@uoguelph.ca> wrote:

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Glenn Penner <gpenner@uoguelph.ca>

Fri, Sep 15, 2017 at 5:05 PM

To: Mike Dirksen <707mike@gmail.com>

Cc: Tim Janzen <tjanzen@comcast.net>

Here are a few recommendations for GRANDMA:

- 1) for Kornelius Duerksen #70539) remove his birth year. This is just a wild guess. Since he could have fathered son Johann anytime between the ages of 20 and 60 his birth year could range from 1706 to 1746.
- 2) Since the birth year for 70539 is a guess I suggest removing the current birth source.
- 3) For his son #14630 the one-and-only document that can be used to estimate his birth year is his age in the 1835 census (69 years). Replace his current birth source with the 1835 census of the Molotschna colony.

I have two comments:

- 1) The notes for both 70539 and 14630 have become much too messy. These notes need to be cleaned up. I was planning on adding some notes from Prussia material but I see no point in burying these in the sea of notes already there.
- 2) In my opinion the Duerksen family history is highly unreliable. This is another example of people from the 1900s trying to put together material on people who lived in the late 1700s and early 1800s, based on unreliable stories that have been passed down through several generations. Fortunately Mike and others have corrected these as much as possible.

Glenn.

From: Mike Dirksen <707mike@gmail.com>
Sent: Friday, September 15, 2017 6:23 PM
To: Glenn Penner
Cc: Tim Janzen
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Mike Dirksen <707mike@gmail.com>
To: Glenn Penner <gpenner@uoguelph.ca>
Cc: Tim Janzen <tjanzen@comcast.net>

Fri, Sep 15, 2017 at 5:30 PM

Comments on Glen's recommendations:

- 1) The notes for both 70539 and 14630 are indeed a mess. I have often started to submit corrections that did not change any data but simply "cleaned up" what is there. I never did make those submissions for fear it might be pretentious.
- 2) I would very much like to see Glenn's notes added.
- 3) The Dirksen family history IS highly unreliable. It started out that way with the documented errors ([Alan Peters June 1995](#)) in John F Duerksen's 1928 history (contained now in the [Marcellus Duerksen Folder](#) in the Fresno archives). The many errors were compounded exponentially by many participants in the 1953 Shafter Duerksen reunion who later received the [Johann Duerksen 1750-1840 pamphlet](#) crafted by Dr. Alvin Walter Gaede between June 1953 and November 1953 when he died. The combination of Gaede's prominence (<http://www.dakotadirksens.com/AlvinWalterGaedeObit.jpg>) in social groups, and his tragic early death, lead to great confidence in the accuracy of his pamphlet, but in fact it was hastily crafted and probably based on colloquial translations of John F Duerksen's erroneous 1928 papers.

I am very enthusiastic about any effort to weed out all of the unsupported or unsubstantiated data.

Mike Dirksen

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Tim Janzen <tjanzen@comcast.net>

Fri, Sep 15, 2017 at 10:00 PM

To: Mike Dirksen <707mike@gmail.com>, Glenn Penner <gpenner@uoguelph.ca>

[See comments below.](#)

Tim

From: Mike Dirksen [mailto:707mike@gmail.com]

Sent: Friday, September 15, 2017 5:31 PM

To: Glenn Penner

Cc: Tim Janzen

Subject: Re: Gerhard Duerksen - Abbotsford

Comments on Glen's recommendations:

1) The notes for both 70539 and 14630 are indeed a mess. I have often started to submit corrections that did not change any data but simply "cleaned up" what is there. I never did make those submissions for fear it might be pretentious.

2) I would very much like to see Glenn's notes added.

3) The Dirksen family history IS highly unreliable. It started out that way with the documented errors (Alan Peters June 1995) in John F Duerksen's 1928 history (contained now in the Marcellus Duerksen Folder in the Fresno archives). The many errors were compounded exponentially by many participants in the 1953 Shafter Duerksen reunion who later received the Johann Duerksen 1750-1840 pamphlet crafted by Dr. Alvin Walter Gaede between June 1953 and November 1953 when he died. The combination of Gaede's prominence (<http://www.dakotadirksens.com/AlvinWalterGaedeObit.jpg>) in social groups, and his tragic early death, lead to great confidence in the accuracy of his pamphlet, but in fact it was hastily crafted and probably based on colloquial translations of John F Duerksen's erroneous 1928 papers.

I am very enthusiastic about any effort to weed out all of the unsupported or unsubstantiated data.

Mike Dirksen

On Fri, Sep 15, 2017 at 5:05 PM, Glenn Penner <gpenner@uoguelph.ca> wrote:

Here are a few recommendations for GRANDMA:

1) for Kornelius Duerksen #70539) remove his birth year.

I did that and added the 1835 Molotschna Census as the source for his name. I deleted the other sources for him too.

This is just a wild guess. Since he could have fathered son Johann anytime between the ages of 20 and 60 his birth year could range from 1706 to 1746.

2) Since the birth year for 70539 is a guess I suggest removing the current birth source.

Yes, done.

3) For his son #14630 the one-and-only document that can be used to estimate his birth year is his age in the 1835 census (69 years). Replace his current birth source with the 1835 census of the Molotschna colony.

Yes, done.

I have two comments:

1) The notes for both 70539 and 14630 have become much too messy. These notes need to be cleaned up. I was planning on adding some notes from Prussia material but I see no point in burying these in the sea of notes already there.

I deleted a little bit from the notes, but much of that content is helpful to have for reference for those who come behind us and who look at John Duerksen's material.

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